

5 of Their Favorite Things

BRENT WELLS • N4BDW

POTA MAPPING REPRESENTATIVE • KENTUCKY



FLEMINGSBURG, KENTUCKY

Brent Wells is an active part of Kentucky's portable-radio community and serves as the **POTA Mapping Representative for Kentucky**. For this founder profile, we asked Brent to share five of his favorite things in three categories: apps he uses for ham radio, websites he relies on for ham radio, and Kentucky POTA parks that have special meaning to him.

THE FIVE FAVORITES

5

Favorite Apps for Ham Radio

HamAlert • QRZ • MyRadar • RadarScope • Discord

5

Favorite Websites for Ham Radio

Palomar • KyGovMaps • POTAmaps • U.S. Forest Service • W5SWL Electronics

5

Favorite Kentucky POTA Parks

Twin Knobs • Pioneer Weapons • Daniel Boone National Forest • E. Lucy Braun SNP • Taylorsville Lake

“Cave Run is where I’m most at peace.”

— BRENT WELLS, N4BDW



5 Favorite Apps for Ham Radio

The five apps Brent chose for staying connected, finding activity, and keeping an eye on conditions in the field.

01

HamAlert

Alerts for amateur-radio activity and stations of interest.

02

QRZ

A go-to resource for callsigns, operator information, and amateur-radio reference.

03

MyRadar

Quick weather radar and weather awareness when heading into the field.

04

RadarScope

Detailed radar information when weather conditions matter to a portable operation.

05

Discord

A convenient way to communicate with other hams and stay connected with the community.

02

5 Favorite Websites for Ham Radio

Resources Brent uses for antennas and RF, mapping, POTA planning, public lands, and electronics.

01

Palomar Engineers

RF, antenna, ferrite, and RFI/EMI resources.

VISIT WEBSITE →

02

KyGovMaps

Kentucky geographic-information and mapping resources.

VISIT WEBSITE →

03

POTAmaps

A useful mapping resource for Parks on the Air planning.

VISIT WEBSITE →

04

U.S. Forest Service Maps

Interactive maps for National Forest lands, access, and planning.

VISIT WEBSITE →

05

W5SWL Electronics

Electronics and amateur-radio resources.

VISIT WEBSITE →



5 Favorite Kentucky POTA Parks

These five parks stand out because of family memories, scenery, peaceful operating, and the people Brent has met through portable radio.

01

Twin Knobs Campground

US-10170

"I grew up camping in Twin Knobs every year. It's right against Cave Run Lake and Cave Run is where I'm most at peace."

[VIEW POTA PARK PAGE →](#)

02

Pioneer Weapons

US-10158

"Similar reason as Twin Knobs, I grew up camping at Cave Run every year. Pioneer Weapons runs along a ridge to a campground on the south side of Cave Run where I also camped as a kid."

[VIEW POTA PARK PAGE →](#)

03

Daniel Boone National Forest

US-4484

"My top two parks lie with Daniel Boone, but there are many other parks within the National Forest as well that are peaceful to activate."

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04

E. Lucy Braun SNP

US-7968

"ONLY ever activated this park once, but it was part of an epic southeastern Kentucky rove that happened to be in the fall. The leaves on the trees were spectacular, and this park resided on an 11 mile unpaved ridge section of the Little Shepherds Trail so 4wheel was needed just to creep over some of the rock washout, though the trip was not extreme or dangerous."

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05

Taylorsville Lake

US-1271

"This park isn't so much about the geographic features, although it's relatively flat and not affected by any neighboring hills, but it's the experiences that happened here. In 2025 it was the site of a POTA Meetup I helped initiate that introduced me to two more of my best buddies today. But in 2026, those two buddies plus one whom POTA introduced me to, we four planned and hosted the first Kentucky POTA Campout which was a tremendous success and brought together 40-50 hams ranging from states other than Kentucky like Pennsylvania, North Carolina, Indiana, Ohio, and Georgia."

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PORTABLE RADIO IS ABOUT THE JOURNEY

For Brent, the best POTA memories are tied to Kentucky's public lands, the outdoors, and the friendships made along the way.